

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



INDIA-CHINA RELATIONS - 1

MODULE - 12

INDIA-CHINA

- 1 India and China are ancient civilisations, economically and politically powerful nations having large populations.
- 2 China has surpassed many of world economies, while India has become a major investment hub for the western economies.
- 3 Trade relations between countries in olden days took place along the Silk Route.
- 4 Formal relations between two countries started after India got independence and conducted its foreign relations as a sovereign nation.
- 5 In 2020, India and China celebrated 70 years of establishment of diplomatic relations.



PHASES IN RELATIONSHIP

1. ANCIENT/ HISTORICAL RELATIONS
2. COLONIAL RELATIONS
3. MILESTONES IN POST-INDEPENDENCE
4. CONTEMPORARY RELATIONS

HISTORICAL RELATIONS BETWEEN NATIONS

1 During the Ancient and Medieval period, the relations between India and China were based on **material exchange and cultural exchange**.

2 This exchange was carried through the following four routes of communication:

1. The Central Asian route or silk route
2. Assam-Burma and Yunnan route or the southern silk route
3. Tibet Nepal route
4. Sea route or maritime silk route



HISTORICAL RELATIONS BETWEEN NATIONS

MATERIAL EXCHANGE

Trade relations were present between India and China in the 4th and the 5th Century.

1 India used to mainly export trade items like coral pearl, glass and fragrances to China. China exported silk, gunpowder, paper manufacturing techniques to India.

2 Indian astronomy, medicine, calendar, music and dance were popular in the China.

3 Calicut, Cochin, Goa, Bombay, Mahabalipuram and Calcutta were important ports for Indo-China trade



HISTORICAL RELATIONS BETWEEN NATIONS

SPIRITUAL AND CULTURAL LINKAGE

Buddhism led to movement of people and ideas between India and China and further development of trade centres.

1 Faxian was the first Chinese traveller to India. He travelled throughout India during the Gupta Dynasty in search of Buddhist scriptures and other reliable sources.

2 Xuanzang and Yijing also arrived in India in 7th century.

3 Among the Indian monks, Kumarvijay (343-413) contributed to the spread of Buddhism. He translated many Sanskrit scriptures into Chinese language.

4 Another Indian monk was Bodhidharma. He went to China in 6th century AD and is considered as the founder of Shaolin martial art in China.

5 Through these exchanges, Hinduism also made inroads to China.



COLONIAL PERIOD

Since the arrival of British colonial period in Asia, the traditional relationships between India and China which had connections in trade, culture and political ideas dwindled

TRADE

- 1 Trade was not completely displaced but modified by the mediation of European traders.
- 2 There was a high demand for Chinese tea. This led to Europe to exchange Indian spices with Chinese tea. the British East India company began to smuggling Indian opium to China.



COLONIAL PERIOD

STRUGGLE FOR INDEPENDENCE

- 1 There was continuous contact between Indian and Chinese nationalists.
- 2 In 1920s, Indian National Congress opposed the use of Indian troops by British.
- 3 India gave assistance to China's war of resistance against Japanese occupation through Indian medical mission in 1930s and 1940s



COLONIAL PERIOD

LEGACY OF BBORDER DISPUTE

- 1 In the early 20th century, British Empire to advance it's colony in South Asia, made lines of control and buffer zones.
- 2 The British drew up the 550 mile McMahon lines at the eastern sector as the border between the British India and Tibet during the Shimla conference in 1913-14. However, China did not accept the line.
- 3 This gave the emergence to rivalry between India and China as both wanted to secure their land.

PEOPLE-TO-PEOPLE CONTACTS

- 1 Rabindranath Tagore visited China in 1924, and promoted spirit of pan-Asian and solidarity
- 2 Indian nationalist Raja Mahendra Pratap also received support from Chinese nationalist leaders



POST INDEPENDENCE RELATIONS

1 Along with India, China got independence in 1949. Asia now had two big independent nations. Culturally, politically and socially, India and China were different.

- 2**
- China underwent a civil war to gain independence, different from India's Satyagraha and Non-violence.
 - India was a democracy and China was an underdeveloped Communist dictatorship.

- 3**
- PM Nehru wanted the developing nations to function without the interference of the superpowers. China under Mao wanted the Third World to bring a global revolution under the leadership of China.
 - Instead of looking inwards and consolidating and reorganizing itself like India, China began its expansionist policies



MILESTONES IN THE RELATIONSHIP

1962 WAR

- 1 The bilateral relationship based on the principles of 'Panchsheel', to provide a lasting solution for peace and stability in Asia.
- 2 In the mid-1950s, China and India came together in the spirit of "Hindi Chini Bhai Bhai" (India and China are brothers).
- 3 India saw China's independence as the 'great Asian Resurgence' and wanted to support her cause. It also supported China's entry into UN.
- 4 China invaded Tibet in 1950, and removed the historical buffer between India and China.
- 5 The Dalai Lama travelled on an official visit to India from November 1956 to February 1957.



MILESTONES IN THE RELATIONSHIP

1962 WAR

- 6 PM Nehru visited Beijing and met Mao Zedong in October 1954. China's official maps laid claims over Aksai Chin and Arunachal Pradesh
- 7 China also alleged that India was allowing and encouraging anti-Chinese activities when it gave asylum to Dalai Lama.
- 8 In 1958, China officially stated that Aksai Chin was its territory. India responded by launching its Forward Policy in 1961.



MILESTONES IN THE RELATIONSHIP

1962 WAR

- 9** People's Liberation Army of China invaded Ladakh and Arunachal Pradesh (then known as the North East Frontier Agency) and India-China war began on October 20, 1962.
- 10** Zhou Enlai proposed a peace-deal to relinquish claim over Arunachal Pradesh if India would give it Askai Chin. PM Nehru rejected it.
- 11** After three weeks, China declared a unilateral ceasefire on 21 November and withdrew from Indian territories. Nehru was criticized for incorrect assessment of the situation and its military preparedness.



MILESTONES IN THE RELATIONSHIP

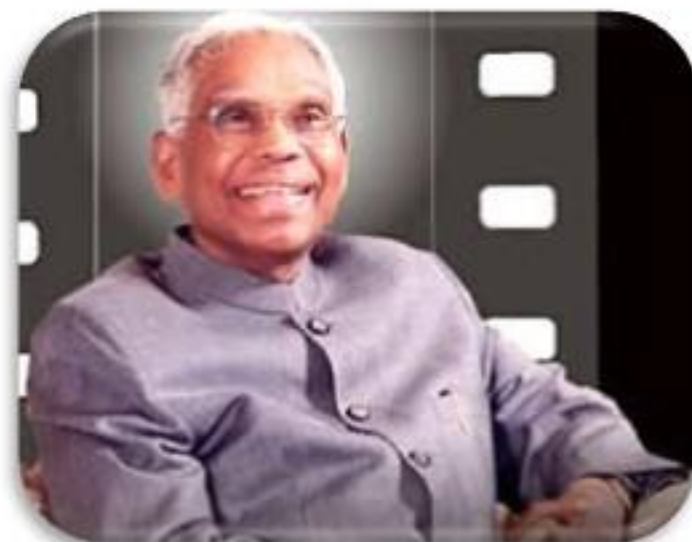
RESUMPTION OF DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS

1 Indira Gandhi emphasized on peace and good-neighborliness with China by expressing her willingness to open boundary talks in 1968.

2 In 1976, Government of India unilaterally announced restoration of diplomatic relations between India and China with the appointment of KR Narayanan as the Ambassador.

3 China welcomed the decision and trade and cultural links were resumed.

4 This revival took place in the backdrop of the changing geopolitical situation- 1971 Indo-Pak war, 1974 Nuclear tests and 1975 merger of Sikkim into India.



MILESTONES IN THE RELATIONSHIP

SUMDORONGCHU STANDOFF

- 1** In 1986, standoff between the Indian and the Chinese armies at Sumdorongchu (east of tri-junction with Bhutan).
- 2** In February 1987, Arunachal Pradesh became a full-fledged state of India.
- 3** Rajiv Gandhi visited China in Both the sides agreed to negotiate a boundary settlement and maintain peace and tranquillity at the boundary.
- 4** India considered Tibet to be an integral part of China and it would not allow Tibetan separatist activities on Indian soil.
- 5** Agreements on cooperation in science and technology and civil aviation transportation were signed.



MILESTONES IN THE RELATIONSHIP

NOMENCLATURE OF LAC

- 1 Prime Minister Narasimha Rao's 1993 visit to China complicated the border resolution.
- 2 Border Peace and Tranquillity Agreement signed in September 1993.
- 3 China said that the entire border should be called the Line of Actual Control
- 4 The Line of Actual Control by definition would be easier to alter than a disputed border even if it was not agreed on maps or on the ground. Being a military-held line, it can be changed by force.



MILESTONES IN THE RELATIONSHIP

NOMENCLATURE OF LAC

5 Sino-Indian Joint Working Group on Boundary Question, to close four closest military posts on the border and to set up four border trade ports besides four meeting points between their armies.

The disputed border acquired three lines:

- The border as perceived by China;
- the border as understood by India;
- and the Line of Actual Control as agreed by both

After India's nuclear tests in 1998, the number of Chinese transgressions inside Indian territories increased.



CONTEMPORARY RELATIONSHIP

- Contemporary issues between India and China at the bilateral, regional and global level will help us in understanding the relationship.
- The areas of contention in the relationship can be categorised into:
 1. POLITICAL AND STRATEGIC
 2. BORDER ISSUES
 3. INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATIONS
 4. ECONOMIC
 5. CYBER SECURITY
 6. WATER DISPUTES



POLITICAL AND STRATEGIC

i ONE BELT ONE ROAD (OBOR) INITIATIVE

The One Belt One Road is an initiative introduced by Chinese President Xi Jinping in 2013 to forward the idea of 'Chin dream' started by Hu Jintao. Belt and Road, or yi dai yi lu, is a "21st century Silk Road

1 It is a part of foreign policy and economic strategy of the People's Republic of China.

2 OBOR includes the overland 'Silk Road Economic Belt' and the '21st-Century Maritime Silk Road'.

3 A state-backed campaign for global dominance. It aims to boost domestic development and foreign diplomacy, enhance connectivity and cultural links.



POLITICAL AND STRATEGIC

i ONE BELT ONE ROAD (OBOR) INITIATIVE

FEATURES OF OBOR

- 1** The Belt and Road runs through continents of China, Central Asia, Russia and Europe.
- 2** The 21st Century Maritime Silk Route has two routes- China to Europe via South China Sea and Indian Ocean; and China to Europe via South China Sea and South Pacific.
- 3** China is carrying out or planning construction projects in more than 60 countries along these routes. China's vision included creating a vast network of railways, energy pipelines, highways, and streamlined border crossings
- 4** Maritime Silk Route is expected to protect the Sea Lanes of Communications (SLOCs) especially the Chinese SLOC to Africa created and maintained by Beijing.



POLITICAL AND STRATEGIC

OBJECTIVES OF OBOR

- 1 OBOR is expected to accelerate the shift of the geo-economic power away from the US towards Eurasia.
- 2
 - China hopes that OBOR will reduce America's threat to trade lifelines.
 - China is using OBOR as a tool to establish new rules and new institutions to reflect Chinese interests, and reshape 'soft' infrastructure
 - It will also expand the international use of the currency Renminbi.
- 3 OBOR would:
 - integrate China's internal markets with those of its neighbours and bring them closer to China
 - bring stability to the region by reducing the separatist activities with economic activities Xinjiang and Tibet,
 - Bring energy security through the construction of OBOR-funded transport routes.



POLITICAL AND STRATEGIC

i ONE BELT ONE ROAD (OBOR) INITIATIVE

CRITICISMS AGAINST OBOR

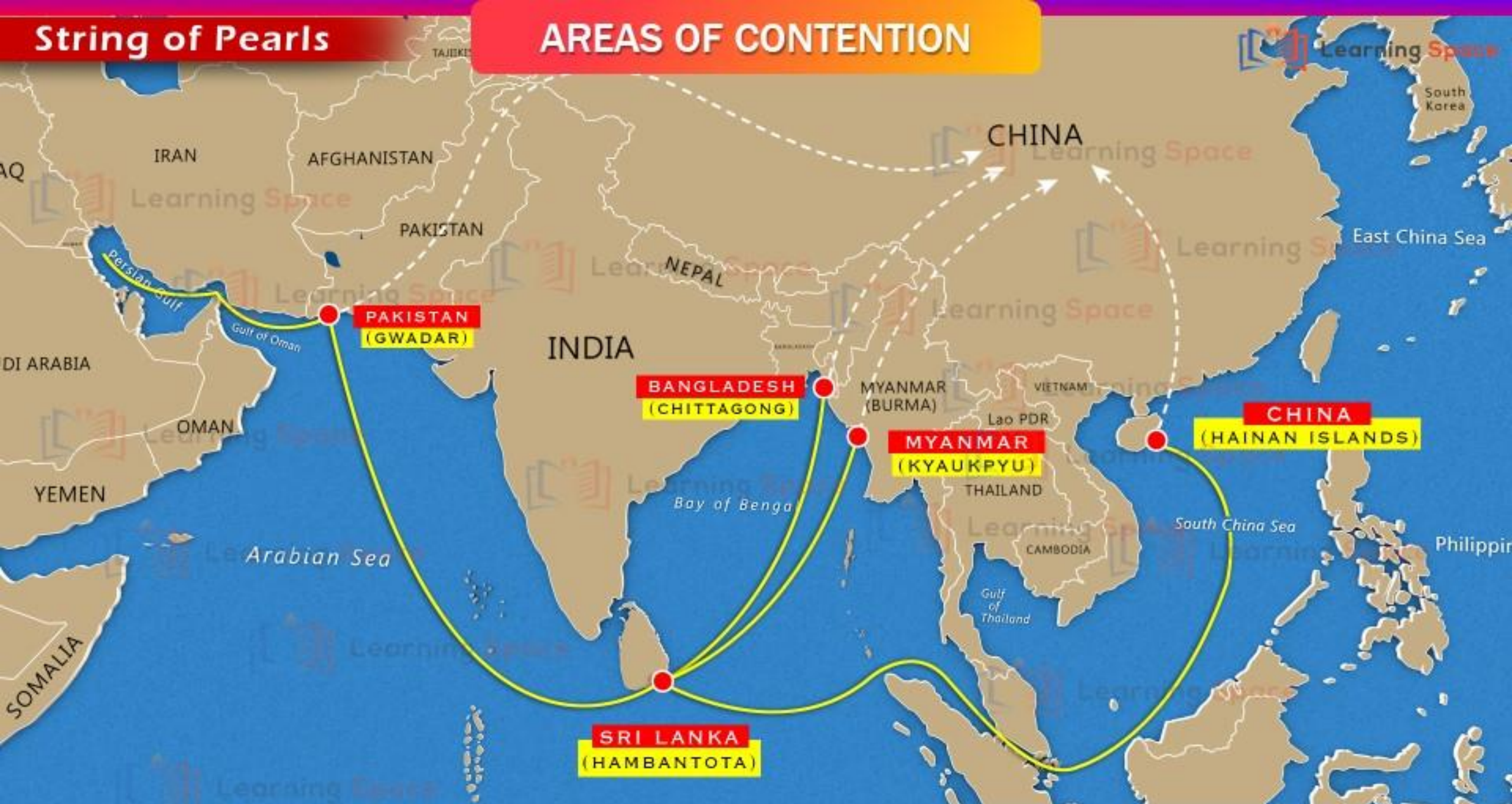
- 1** US fears that OBOR is an extension of efforts by China to undermine the security and economic architecture of the current international order
- 2** The OBOR was designed to be able to export China's excess labour, excess capital and excess production facilities. Thus China was trying to solve one of its own domestic problems
- 3** Prime Minister of Malaysia, has described OBOR as a form of "new colonialism". Investment decisions are driven by geopolitical needs instead of sound financial sense



According to 2016 CSIS report, none of the Indian Ocean port projects funded through OBOR hope to bring financial success

String of Pearls

AREAS OF CONTENTION



INDIA'S INTEREST IN OBOR

ADVANTAGES

- 1 India can gain technical know-how to address its own infrastructural bottlenecks through OBOR.
- 2 India can benefit through regional transport, energy security, and blue economy
- 3 Maritime Silk Route is expected to enhance connectivity between Indian Ocean and Western Pacific and expand ocean trade markets



INDIA'S OBJECTIONS TO IN OBOR

CHINA-PAKISTAN ECONOMIC CORRIDOR (CPEC)

India is the only major country in the world to have opposed the OBOR project on the grounds of territorial sovereignty.

China-Pakistan Economic Corridor (CPEC) is a part of OBOR.

- 1 CPEC will connect Kashgar in China's Xinjiang province with the Gwadar port. The new Silk Road would connect the energy fields of the Middle East and markets of Europe to China.

- 2 The establishment of a project with China in the disputed territory gives Pakistan's occupation of the area a degree of legitimacy.



AREAS OF CONTENTION

OBJECTIONS

INDIA'S INTEREST IN OBOR

CHINA-PAKISTAN ECONOMIC CORRIDOR (CPEC)

- 3 India feels projects in Gilgit-Baltistan affect India's sovereignty and territorial integrity.
- 4 The route of CPEC passes through POK and makes China an indirect stakeholder in Kashmir conflict between India and Pakistan.



INDIA'S OBJECTIONS TO IN OBOR

SECURITY CONSIDERATIONS

- 1 India fears OBOR would shift the status quo in sensitive areas like Kashmir and the South China Sea.
- 2 China is countering India's strategies and promote its presence in North East. This may have a security impact on India.
- 3 China's undeclared policy of String of Pearls of encircling India by developing ports and naval bases around India's maritime reaches show signs of Neo-Colonialism in this project
- 4 Most of India's trade and 89% of India's oil imports takes place through sea. China's influence in Indian Ocean, India fears, might block crucial trade channels



INDIA'S OBJECTIONS TO IN OBOR

FUNCTIONING OF OBOR

- 1 There is a lack of transparency in the functioning of OBOR.
- 2 India feels it is not just an economic project but is been used by China for gaining political control.

SOFT POWER

- 1 China may gain cultural hegemony in the South Asia which may prove counter-productive to India.
- 2 Buddhism travelled along the Silk route from India to other parts of the world.

MARITIME SILK ROUTE (MSR)

- 1 By creating maritime infrastructure corridor in the broader Indo-Pacific region, Maritime Silk Route aims to enhance China's interests in the Indian Ocean region and establish its foothold.
- 2 China's access to Gwadar port will particularly help it in affecting the security and governance of Indian Ocean Region.



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